

FOR COACHES WHOSE CALENDAR IS ABOUT TO FILL UP

The Perfect Discovery Call Script

The word-for-word framework top coaches use to turn free strategy calls into paying clients — without feeling salesy

The exact questions • The exact order • The exact words for every objection

Read this before your next call

Most coaches lose the sale in the first 10 minutes — and they lose it by talking. They get a stranger on a free call, get nervous, and start explaining their program, their method, their certifications. The prospect nods politely, says "let me think about it," and disappears forever.

Here's what took me way too long to learn: **a discovery call is not a presentation. It's a diagnosis.** Think about the last time a doctor earned your trust. They didn't open with a speech about medical school. They asked questions. Where does it hurt? How long has it been like this? What makes it worse? By the time they told you what to do, you were already sold — because they clearly understood your problem better than you did.

That's this entire script in one sentence: **ask questions that reveal pain, and let the prospect sell themselves.** People don't buy coaching because your program sounds good. They buy because, somewhere during the call, they heard themselves say out loud how much staying stuck is costing them — and they couldn't unhear it.

The 4 rules that make this script work

Rule 1: They talk 70%, you talk 30%. If you're talking more than them, you're losing. Every minute they spend describing their problem is a minute they spend convincing themselves they need help.

Rule 2: Never skip a phase. The order matters more than the words. Pain before solution. Stakes before price. Coaches who jump to pitching because "the vibe was good" get ghosted by people who loved the call.

Rule 3: Get comfortable with silence. After you ask a deep question, shut up. Count to five in your head if you have to. The answer that comes after the awkward pause is always the real one.

Rule 4: Write down their exact words. Not summaries — their words. "I feel like I'm failing my family" closes deals. "Client has motivation issues" doesn't. You'll use their words back to them in Phase 6.

A note on ethics, because it matters: this script is not about manipulating anyone. It's about refusing to let a surface-level conversation waste both of your time. If someone genuinely isn't a fit, this framework surfaces that fast — and you tell them so. The goal is truth on the call. Truth closes better than pressure ever will.

The 5-minute pre-call ritual

Winging it is how you end up rambling. Five minutes before every call, run this checklist:

- 1. Review their booking form.** If your website's lead form asked why they booked (it should), read their answer twice. Your first real question will build directly on it — nothing builds trust faster than "I read what you wrote when you booked."
- 2. Write their name on a sticky note.** Sounds silly. Works. Using their name 3-4 times during a call measurably changes how connected they feel.
- 3. Open a blank notes page with 3 headings:** PAIN (their words), GOAL (their words), COST (what staying stuck costs them). If those three sections are full by minute 20, the close writes itself.
- 4. Decide your outcome before you dial.** The outcome of a discovery call is a decision — yes or no. Not "I'll send you some info." Not "think it over and email me." A kind, clear decision.
- 5. Say this to yourself once:** "I'm not trying to get a client. I'm finding out if I can help." That posture — genuinely curious, zero neediness — is the single most attractive energy you can bring to a sales call.

PART 1

The Call, Phase By Phase

Seven phases, in order, with the exact words. Timings assume a 45-minute call — adjust proportionally for 30. The phase most coaches rush is Phase 3. The phase that makes you money is Phase 3. That is not a coincidence.

1

The Opening — Take Control Kindly

MINUTES 0-3

The first 60 seconds decide who's leading the call. Lead it. Not by dominating — by giving the call a structure so the prospect can relax. People trust the person holding the map.

SAY THIS — WORD FOR WORD

"Hey [NAME], great to meet you! Before we dive in — how's your day going so far?"

(Let them answer. Small talk for 30-60 seconds max. Then:)

"Awesome. So here's how I like to run these calls, if that works for you: first, I'm going to ask you a bunch of questions about where you're at and where you want to be — I want to actually understand your situation before I say anything about mine. Then, if it looks like I can genuinely help, I'll walk you through exactly what that would look like. And if I can't, I'll tell you that too and point you in a better direction. Sound fair?"

(Wait for the yes. You need it out loud.)

WHY IT WORKS: "Sound fair?" gets their first small yes and gives you permission to ask personal questions for the next 30 minutes. The "if I can't help, I'll tell you" line kills sales-resistance before it forms — they stop bracing for a pitch.

2

Current State — Get The Facts

MINUTES 3-8

Start easy. Facts before feelings. These questions warm them up and give you the landscape — but don't camp here. This phase is the on-ramp, not the highway.

ASK THESE, IN ROUGHLY THIS ORDER

"So tell me — what's going on with [THEIR AREA / YOUR NICHE] right now? Walk me through where things are at."

"How long has it been like this?"

"And what made you book this call *now*? Because you could have booked it six months ago, or six months from now. Why today?"

WHY IT WORKS: "Why now?" is the most underrated question in sales. Something specific pushed them to book — a bad day, a breaking point, a birthday, a comment someone made. That trigger IS the sale. Write it down word for word.

3

Pain Excavation — Go Three Layers Deep

MINUTES 8-20

This is the heart of the call, so I'm giving it more room than any other phase. Here's the thing about pain: the first answer a prospect gives you is never the real one. It's the rehearsed one — the version

they tell coworkers. Your job is to go three layers down: **Layer 1 is the surface problem. Layer 2 is the impact on their life. Layer 3 is what it means about them.** Deals close at layer 3.

LAYER 1 — THE SURFACE PROBLEM

"Okay, so out of everything you just mentioned — what's the single most frustrating part of all this for you?"

"What have you already tried to fix it?"

"And what happened when you tried that?" (*Ask this after EVERY attempt they list. Let them relive each dead end.*)

LAYER 2 — THE IMPACT ON THEIR LIFE

"How is this actually affecting your day-to-day? Like, where does it show up?"

"Who else feels it when this isn't going well? Your partner? Your kids? Your team?"

"What is this costing you right now — in money, in time, in energy? Have you ever actually added it up?"

"What's it costing you that *isn't* measurable?"

LAYER 3 — WHAT IT MEANS ABOUT THEM

"Can I ask you something a little deeper? When it's late and it's quiet and you think about this... what's the thought that keeps coming back?"

"How is this affecting how you feel about yourself?"

"Let's say nothing changes — same patterns, same results. Where does this honestly end up in a year? In three?"

(*Then silence. Do not rescue them from this question. Count to five. Let them sit in it.*)

WHY IT WORKS: Nobody pays [YOUR PRICE] to fix a surface problem. They pay it to stop feeling what they just described in Layer 3. And notice: you didn't create that pain. You just asked the questions that let them finally say it out loud — often for the first time ever. That alone is worth the call to them.

The magic follow-up that unlocks every layer: "Tell me more about that." That's it. Five words. When they say something with even a flicker of emotion behind it — a sigh, a pause, a joke that isn't really a joke — say "tell me more about that" and go quiet. It out-performs every clever question in this pack.

4

The Dream — Build The Other Side

MINUTES 20–26

You've opened the wound; now show the healed version. Get them describing the future in vivid, specific detail. The contrast between Phase 3 and Phase 4 creates the gap — and your coaching is the bridge across it.

ASK THESE

"Okay, let's flip it. Imagine we're talking a year from now and this worked — like, actually worked. What does your life look like? Paint me the picture."

"What would that make possible that isn't possible today?"

"And what would it mean to you, personally, to finally have that handled?"

"On a scale of 1 to 10 — how important is it to you that this actually happens this time?"

(If they say 8+, ask:) "Why that number and not a 4?"

WHY IT WORKS: "Why an 8 and not a 4?" makes them argue FOR their own commitment. Every reason they give is them closing themselves. This is judo: you never push — you ask, and they push themselves.

5

The Gap — Why Alone Hasn't Worked

MINUTES 26–30

One honest question stands between discovery and your pitch. It gets the prospect to admit — in their own words — that doing it alone is the broken strategy. After they say it, hiring you stops being an expense and becomes the obvious fix.

THE BRIDGE QUESTION

"So here's what I'm noticing, [NAME]. You clearly know what you want — you just described it perfectly. And you've been trying to get there for [TIMEFRAME]. So let me ask you the honest question: what do you think has actually been missing?"

(Let them answer fully. Then:)

"And if you keep going the way you've been going — alone, same approach — do you genuinely believe you'll get there? Honestly?"

WHY IT WORKS: Nine times out of ten, they answer with some version of "accountability," "structure," "a plan," or "someone who's done it." Congratulations — they just listed your product. You didn't claim they need coaching. They did.

6

The Prescription — Pitch In Their Words

MINUTES 30–36

Now — and only now — you talk. But you're not presenting a program; you're prescribing a treatment. Keep it under five minutes. Use the exact words from your PAIN / GOAL / COST notes. Their words,

mirrored back, sound like truth. Your words sound like marketing.

SAY THIS — THEN TAILOR THE MIDDLE

"Okay [NAME], thank you for being this open with me — genuinely. Based on everything you've shared... yes, I can help you. And I want to show you what that would look like. Can I walk you through it?"

"You told me the real problem is [THEIR LAYER 2-3 PAIN, THEIR WORDS]. And that what's been missing is [THEIR PHASE 5 ANSWER]. That's exactly what we fix. Here's how it works: [2-3 SENTENCES — your format, frequency, and the FIRST thing you'd tackle together. No feature lists.]"

"In the first [TIMEFRAME], the goal is [FIRST MILESTONE TIED TO THEIR DREAM]. From there we build toward [THEIR PHASE 4 PICTURE, THEIR WORDS]."

"The investment is [PRICE]."

(Then stop talking. Completely. The first person to speak after the price loses the frame. This silence will feel like a year. Hold it.)

WHY IT WORKS: "Can I walk you through it?" earns a yes, so the pitch arrives invited, not inflicted. Saying the price plainly — no discount-flinch, no nervous laugh, no "I know it's a lot" — communicates more confidence than anything else on the call.

7

The Close — Ask And Decide

MINUTES 36–45

Most coaches do everything right and then never actually ask. Ask. Kindly, directly, once.

THE ASK

(After price-silence, whatever they say, respond to it, then:)

"So — where's your head at? Based on everything we talked about, do you want to do this?"

(If YES:) "Amazing. Here's exactly what happens next: [PAYMENT STEP], then [ONBOARDING STEP], and our first session is [WHEN]. Let's get the first part done right now while we're together so it's off your plate."

(If NO / a fit problem you spotted:) "I appreciate the honesty — and truthfully, I don't think we're the right fit either, because [REASON]. Here's what I'd do instead: [GENUINE FREE DIRECTION]. This call was still worth it if it got you clarity."

WHY IT WORKS: Handling payment on the call isn't pushy — it's kind. "I'll send you a link" is where deals go to die; life happens, doubt creeps back, and the moment of decision passes. Help them finish the decision they just made.

PART 2

The Objection Playbook

Objections aren't rejection — they're the last 10% of the sale asking for help. Every objection below gets the same 3-step treatment: agree first, ask a question second, reframe third. Never argue. You can win an argument and lose the client.

"I can't afford it."

SAY THIS

"Totally fair — and I'd never want you to do something financially reckless. Can I ask you something first, though?"

"Earlier you told me this is costing you [THEIR STATED COST — money, opportunity, health, relationship strain]. If nothing changes, what does another year of that add up to?"

"So the real question isn't whether this costs money. It's which is more expensive — fixing it, or keeping it. Which one do you believe it is?"

WHY IT WORKS: You're not dismissing the money concern — you're weighing it against a number THEY gave you in Phase 3. This only lands if you did the pain work. (Another reason to never skip Phase 3.)

"I need to think about it."

SAY THIS

"Of course — this is a real decision and I want you to feel good about it. Can I ask, so I can actually help: what specifically do you need to think through? Usually it's one of three things — the money, the time, or whether it'll really work for you. Which one is it?"

(They will name one. It's almost never "all three." Now you're handling ONE real objection instead of a fog.)

"Got it. Let's think about it together right now, while it's all fresh — because a week from now, this whole conversation will be a blur and you'll be deciding from memory instead of clarity."

WHY IT WORKS: "I need to think about it" is not an objection — it's a curtain with an objection hiding behind it. The three-options question pulls the curtain. Whatever they name, handle that one and re-ask.

"I need to talk to my partner / spouse."

SAY THIS

"That makes complete sense — big decisions should be team decisions. Two quick questions: first, if it were 100% up to you, would you do it?"

(Get this answer. If it's yes, the sale is alive. If it's no, the partner isn't the real objection — go find it.)

"Okay. And what do you think [PARTNER] will ask about it? Let's get you ready to answer those questions — because 'I found a coach' and 'here's the problem, here's what it's costing us, here's the plan' are two very different conversations."

"Last thing — let's put a time on the calendar for [SPECIFIC DAY] to reconnect after you two talk. That way this doesn't just drift."

WHY IT WORKS: "If it were up to you" separates the real objection from the stated one. Prepping their partner-conversation makes you an ally, not a pressure source. The scheduled follow-up keeps the decision alive instead of dissolving into "I'll let you know."

"I've been burned by a coach / program before."

SAY THIS

"I'm honestly glad you told me that — and I'm sorry it happened. Can you tell me what went wrong?"

(Listen fully. Do not defend the industry. Then:)

"That would have frustrated me too. So here's how what I do is specifically different on exactly that point: [DIRECT CONTRAST — if they got a generic course, you're 1-on-1; if they got no access, you're a message away; if there was no plan, they saw your diagnosis process live on this very call]."

"And honestly? The fact that you got burned and STILL booked this call tells me how much this matters to you."

WHY IT WORKS: Past-burn prospects are often your best closes — they've proven they'll invest; they just need a reason to believe this time is different. Give them the specific contrast, not a generic reassurance.

"Can you send me some information / your prices by email?"

SAY THIS

"I could — but honestly, an email can't answer the only question that matters, which is whether this will work for YOUR situation. That's what this call is for."

"So let's do this instead: give me 10 more minutes, ask me the hardest questions you've got, and by the end you'll know more than any PDF could tell you. What's the biggest question on your mind right now?"

WHY IT WORKS: "Send me info" is a polite exit. Don't block the door — make staying more valuable than leaving. Inviting their hardest question flips them from escaping the call to engaging with it.

PART 3

The Pain Question Bank

25 extra discovery questions, organized by what they reveal. You will never use all of them on one call — pick the 2-3 per category that fit your niche, and keep the rest in reserve for when a call stalls.

Questions that reveal the trigger (why now)

- › "What happened recently that made this feel urgent?"
- › "Was there a specific moment when you thought, 'okay, I actually need help with this'?"
- › "What are you afraid happens if you're still in this exact spot next year?"
- › "Who or what is waiting on you to figure this out?"
- › "If this call didn't exist, what was your plan?"

Questions that reveal the real cost

- › "What has this already cost you that you can't get back?"
- › "What opportunities have you said no to because of this?"
- › "How much money do you estimate this has cost you so far — roughly?"
- › "What does your [partner / team / family] say about it?"
- › "What's the version of you that shows up on the days this is going badly?"

Questions that reveal failed attempts (and why you're different)

- › "What's everything you've tried so far — even the small stuff?"
- › "Which attempt got the closest to working? What happened?"
- › "When you've fallen off track before, what usually knocks you off?"
- › "What did the last thing you tried NOT give you that you needed?"
- › "Be honest — how much of what you already know are you actually doing?"

Questions that reveal identity-level pain (use gently)

- › "What's the story you tell yourself about why this hasn't worked yet?"
- › "How long have you been carrying this on your own?"
- › "What would the people closest to you notice if this was finally handled?"
- › "If your best friend described your situation, what would they say?"
- › "What are you most tired of?"

Questions that reveal commitment (pre-close temperature checks)

- › "If we found the right plan today, is there anything that would stop you from starting?"
- › "What would need to be true for you to say yes to something like this?"
- › "How ready are you, really — not to want this, but to work for it?"
- › "If I could remove your single biggest obstacle, which one would you pick?"
- › "What would make this call a win for you?"

The One-Page Cheat Sheet

Print this page. Keep it next to you on every call until the flow is muscle memory.

PHASE	GOAL	KEY LINE
1. Opening (0–3)	Set the frame, get first yes	"...Sound fair?"
2. Current state (3–8)	Facts + the booking trigger	"Why today?"
3. Pain — 3 layers (8–20)	Surface → life impact → identity	"Tell me more about that."
4. Dream (20–26)	Vivid future + commitment level	"Why an 8 and not a 4?"
5. The gap (26–30)	They name what's missing	"What's actually been missing?"
6. Prescription (30–36)	Pitch in THEIR words, state price	"The investment is [PRICE]." (silence)
7. Close (36–45)	A decision, on the call	"Do you want to do this?"

The 6 commandments

1. They talk 70%. You talk 30%.
2. No pitching before Phase 6. Ever. Even when they ask early — "great question, I'll get to exactly that in a few minutes, because the answer depends on what you tell me next."
3. Write down their exact words. Sell with their vocabulary, not yours.
4. After the price and after big questions: silence. Five full seconds.
5. Every call ends in a decision — yes, no, or a scheduled follow-up with a date. Never "maybe."
6. Disqualify bad fits proudly. Every no you give makes your yes worth more.

After every call, grade yourself on one metric only: "Did I understand their real pain — the Layer 3 stuff — before I said a single word about my coaching?" If yes, the closes will come, even if this one didn't. If no, re-read Phase 3 and run it again tomorrow. This is a skill. Skills are built on reps, and your new website is about to send you plenty of them.

Your calendar fills the leads. This script closes them. Go take the next call.